

CrowdStrike Fal.Con 2026: AI is the new battleground

Maintain Rating: NEUTRAL | PO: 230.00 USD | Price: 214.97 USD

AI strategy on full display; Guardian & SafeMind stand out

We attended CrowdStrike’s Fal.con 2026 conference and walked away more confident in both CrowdStrike’s gravitational pull at the center of the industry and the company’s rapidly evolving AI strategy. This was the largest Falcon event to date, with ~10,000 customers and partners in attendance and an electric atmosphere. More importantly, CrowdStrike paired that ecosystem momentum with a significant product cycle, unveiling Falcon Guardian, SafeMind, a Superintelligence Lab, Agentic Identity, enhancements to Agentic SOC, and more. The core message was clear: AI is the new attack surface, and CrowdStrike’s runtime presence across endpoints and cloud workloads positions it as a leading contender to secure the agentic era.

Paths to \$10B and \$20B ARR targets improve by one year

CrowdStrike pulled forward both of its long-term ARR objectives by one year, now targeting \$10bn in FY30 versus FY31 previously and \$20bn within FY35 versus FY36. The near-term outlook also improved, with management expecting 20%+ nnARR growth in FY28. Applied to the FY27 nnARR midpoint of \$1.355bn, this implies at least approximately \$1.626bn of FY28 nnARR, vs consensus’ \$1.537bn. Management’s confidence reflects recent execution, including record Q2 nnARR of \$333mn, up 51% y/y, as well as sustained Falcon Flex adoption and an expanding AI security opportunity. The profitability framework also improved, with FY28 FCF margin expected to reach at least 32.5% despite CapEx increasing to 11-12% of revenue.

See further analysis inside report

Estimates (Jan) (US\$)	2025A	2026A	2027E	2028E	2029E
EPS	0.97	0.93	1.26	1.65	2.12
GAAP EPS	(0.02)	(0.18)	(0.10)	(0.13)	0.09
EPS Change (YoY)	26.0%	-4.1%	35.5%	31.0%	28.5%
Consensus EPS (Bloomberg)			1.25	1.60	NA
Consensus EPS (Visible Alpha)			1.25	1.59	2.05
Valuation (Jan)					
P/E	221.6x	231.2x	170.6x	130.3x	101.4x
GAAP P/E	NM	NM	NM	NM	2,388.6x
EV / EBITDA*	158.1x	121.9x	103.7x	88.8x	69.4x
Free Cash Flow Yield*	0.5%	0.6%	0.8%	1.1%	1.3%

* For full definitions of *IQmethod*SM measures, see page 8.

04 September 2026

Equity

Tal Liani
Research Analyst
BofAS
+1 646 855 5107
tal.liani@bofa.com

Trevor Dodds
Research Analyst
BofAS
+1 415 940 4065
trevor.dodds@bofa.com

Stock Data

Price	214.97 USD
Price Objective	230.00 USD
Date Established	24-Jul-2026
Investment Opinion	C-2-9
52-Week Range	85.68 USD - 233.88 USD
Mkrt Val (mn) / Shares Out (mn)	220,115 USD / 1,023.9
Free Float	97.4%
Average Daily Value (mn)	2022.09 USD
BofA Ticker / Exchange	CRWD / NAS
Bloomberg / Reuters	CRWD US / CRWD.OQ
ROE (2027E)	25.2%
Net Dbt to Eqty (Jan-2026A)	-100.3%

nnARR = Net New Annual Recurring Revenue

TAM = Total Addressable Market

CAGR = Compound Annual Growth Rate

SIEM = Security Information & Event Management

SOC = Security Operations Center

AIDR = AI Detection & Response

iQprofileSM CrowdStrike Holdings Inc.

iQmethodSM – Bus Performance*

(US\$ Millions)	2025A	2026A	2027E	2028E	2029E
Return on Capital Employed	16.3%	15.5%	17.3%	18.2%	18.7%
Return on Equity	34.3%	24.6%	25.2%	25.6%	25.9%
Operating Margin	21.2%	21.7%	25.1%	27.1%	28.4%
Free Cash Flow	1,068	1,241	1,840	2,376	2,913

iQmethodSM – Quality of Earnings*

(US\$ Millions)	2025A	2026A	2027E	2028E	2029E
Cash Realization Ratio	1.4x	1.7x	1.8x	1.9x	1.7x
Asset Replacement Ratio	0.6x	0.5x	0.9x	2.1x	1.7x
Tax Rate	10.7%	3.3%	NM	NM	NM
Net Debt-to-Equity Ratio	-107.8%	-100.3%	-90.1%	-100.2%	-106.1%
Interest Cover	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA

Income Statement Data (Jan)

(US\$ Millions)	2025A	2026A	2027E	2028E	2029E
Sales	3,954	4,812	6,001	7,305	8,854
% Change	29.4%	21.7%	24.7%	21.7%	21.2%
Gross Profit	3,089	3,762	4,726	5,767	7,005
% Change	29.7%	21.8%	25.6%	22.0%	21.5%
EBITDA	1,370	1,777	2,089	2,439	3,120
% Change	31.2%	29.7%	17.5%	16.8%	27.9%
Net Interest & Other Income	(81)	(33)	11	7	11
Net Income (Adjusted)	971	957	1,321	1,765	2,316
% Change	29.2%	-1.5%	38.0%	33.7%	31.2%

Free Cash Flow Data (Jan)

(US\$ Millions)	2025A	2026A	2027E	2028E	2029E
Net Income from Cont Operations (GAAP)	(20)	(183)	(97)	(136)	100
Depreciation & Amortization	533	731	581	458	604
Change in Working Capital	0	(54)	359	1,097	1,006
Deferred Taxation Charge	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Other Adjustments, Net	868	1,119	1,537	1,901	2,216
Capital Expenditure	(314)	(371)	(540)	(945)	(1,013)
Free Cash Flow	1,068	1,241	1,840	2,376	2,913
% Change	13.6%	16.3%	48.2%	29.1%	22.6%
Share / Issue Repurchase	104	129	2	0	0
Cost of Dividends Paid	0	0	0	0	0
Change in Debt	0	0	0	0	0

Balance Sheet Data (Jan)

(US\$ Millions)	2025A	2026A	2027E	2028E	2029E
Cash & Equivalents	4,323	5,230	6,167	8,543	11,456
Trade Receivables	1,129	1,362	1,699	1,471	1,783
Other Current Assets	663	827	971	1,138	1,379
Property, Plant & Equipment	789	976	1,252	1,739	2,148
Other Non-Current Assets	1,800	2,691	3,860	3,899	3,805
Total Assets	8,703	11,087	13,949	16,789	20,571
Short-Term Debt	0	0	0	0	0
Other Current Liabilities	3,461	4,184	5,190	6,002	7,187
Long-Term Debt	744	745	746	746	746
Other Non-Current Liabilities	1,178	1,684	1,996	2,260	2,540
Total Liabilities	5,383	6,614	7,933	9,008	10,473
Total Equity	3,319	4,473	6,017	7,782	10,098
Total Equity & Liabilities	8,702	11,087	13,949	16,789	20,571

* For full definitions of iQmethodSM measures, see page 8.

Company Sector

Cyber Security

Company Description

CrowdStrike is a leader in the Endpoint Protection Platform (EPP) market. EPP solutions help protect enterprises' internet-connected devices from cyber attacks, and there is a market shift from signature-based on-prem solutions to cloud-based platforms using AI and machine learning. CrowdStrike's platform is one of the few 100% cloud-based architectures and is uniquely positioned to displace incumbents with its platform breadth, including advanced detection and remediation capabilities.

Investment Rationale

We rate CRWD Neutral. We believe CRWD is positioned to gain share in the EPP market and expand into other areas of security over time with its scalable cloud-native, next-generation endpoint platform. We favor CRWD's best-in-class subscription growth and NRR and expect the company's SaaS model and new offerings to deliver sustainable high growth as the company invests to gain market share. However, the high valuation coupled with slowing growth is limiting upside to the current share price.

Stock Data

Average Daily Volume 9,406,390

Quarterly Earnings Estimates

	2026	2027
Q1	0.18A	0.27A
Q2	0.23A	0.31A
Q3	0.24A	0.31E
Q4	0.28A	0.37E

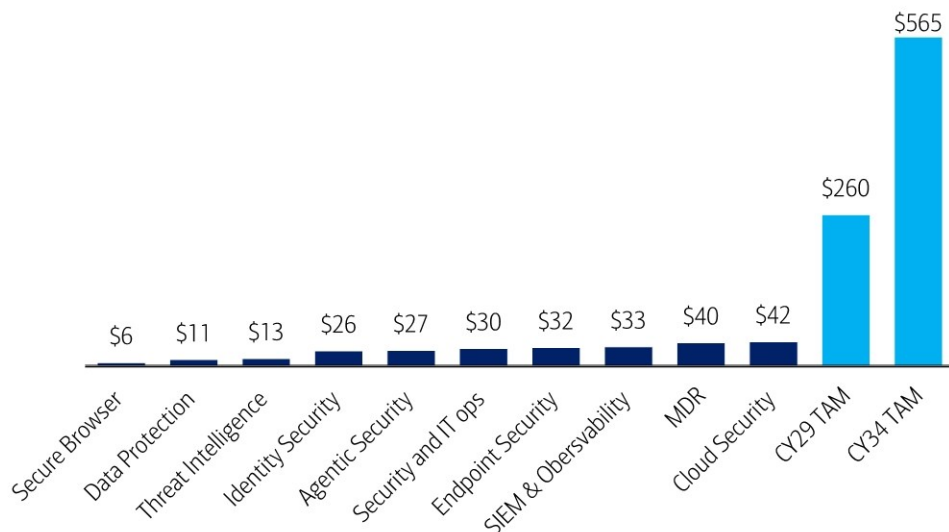


Expanded TAM supports \$20B ARR milestone

CrowdStrike estimates its TAM will reach \$565bn by CY34 (up from \$140B in CY26), supporting the path to \$20bn of ARR. This would imply ~3.5% market share, below the ~4% average share over the past six years. AI security represents the largest incremental opportunity, with a \$215bn CY34 TAM, comprised of \$115bn for Agentic Security, \$52bn for the Agentic SOC, and \$48bn for agentic identity. At 3.5% share, these markets could contribute \$7.5bn of ARR, or 38% of the \$20bn target. The opportunity is not solely dependent on new categories. CrowdStrike estimates \$29bn of whitespace within its installed base, up from \$21bn a year ago, while the CY34 international opportunity is estimated at \$244bn. With roughly 100,000 current customer organizations, there is substantial new-logo runway across enterprise, commercial, and SMB markets.

Exhibit 1: CrowdStrike's TAM is expected to reach \$565bn by CY34

The TAM is expected to grow at a 17% CAGR from CY29 to CY34



Source: BofA Global Research estimates, company report

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

AIDR gets its flagship product with Falcon Guardian

CrowdStrike previously introduced AI detection and response, or AIDR, as a new security category; Falcon Guardian is now the core product intended to lead it. Guardian discovers AI applications and agents, observes their behavior, applies governance and runtime controls, and connects prompt activity with process-level execution. This prompt-to-process context is important because a benign-looking prompt can still produce malicious activity at runtime. Guardian can protect agents operating across endpoints, cloud workloads, and SaaS environments, while CrowdStrike's forthcoming AI Gateway will provide additional visibility and enforcement and can coexist with third-party gateways. The initial AIDR offering experienced a 79x increase in uptake during its first three months, versus a 10x increase for EDR three quarters after launch, although the comparison spans very different stages of CrowdStrike's development. Guardian became generally available during the conference and can be activated by Flex customers as a license entitlement against the existing sensor footprint. Pricing will increase relative to the initial AIDR product, reflecting the broader functionality.

SafeMind brings frontier-caliber AI to defenders

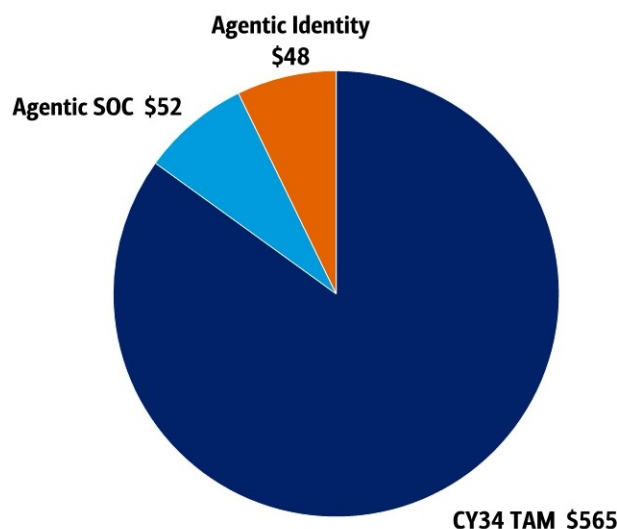
In addition to securing AI with products like Guardian, CrowdStrike announced meaningful steps to get frontier AI in the hands of cyber defenders. The strategy starts with CrowdStrike's new Superintelligence Lab, meant to develop frontier, cyber-focused models through partnership with Nvidia. There are two main models today: Red Tempest for offensive security and Blue Solano for defensive security. Then, CrowdStrike's SafeMind product and harness adds proprietary context, data, and a self-improving feedback loop. Safemind marks CrowdStrike's first foray into capturing token economics through "token packs" consumed in Falcon Flex. We are bullish on this incremental and consumption-based AI revenue stream. CrowdStrike remains committed to openness and noted that SafeMind is intended to work with third-party models as needed. Preview and initial rollout are expected during the back half of the year, with SafeMind contemplated in next year's outlook, but not the current year.

AI SOC and Agentic Identity extend the platform

CrowdStrike's Agentic SOC builds on a Next-Gen SIEM business already approaching \$700mn of ARR and growing approximately 60%. The Agentic SOC TAM is estimated at \$52bn by CY34, supporting a path to \$1.8bn of ARR, just a 13% CAGR from the current base. The product strategy is to use agents to discover, investigate, decide, and respond at machine speed as AI-driven attacks compress breakout and investigation times toward zero. Agentic Identity addresses the related problem of securing human, non-human, and agent identities through zero-standing privilege. Rather than granting persistent access, the platform provides narrowly scoped permissions for a specific task and removes them when the task is complete. CrowdStrike's identity business is already near \$585mn of ARR and growing 33%; reaching the company's illustrative \$1.7bn CY34 target would require a 14% CAGR. Together, Agentic SOC and Agentic Identity further expand CrowdStrike beyond endpoint detection into the data, automation, and access-control layers required for an agentic enterprise.

Exhibit 2: Agentic SOC & Identity CY34 Estimates

CRWD needs to capture just 3.5% of the Agentic SOC & Identity to reach the CY34 ARR targets



Source: BofA Global Research estimates, company report

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

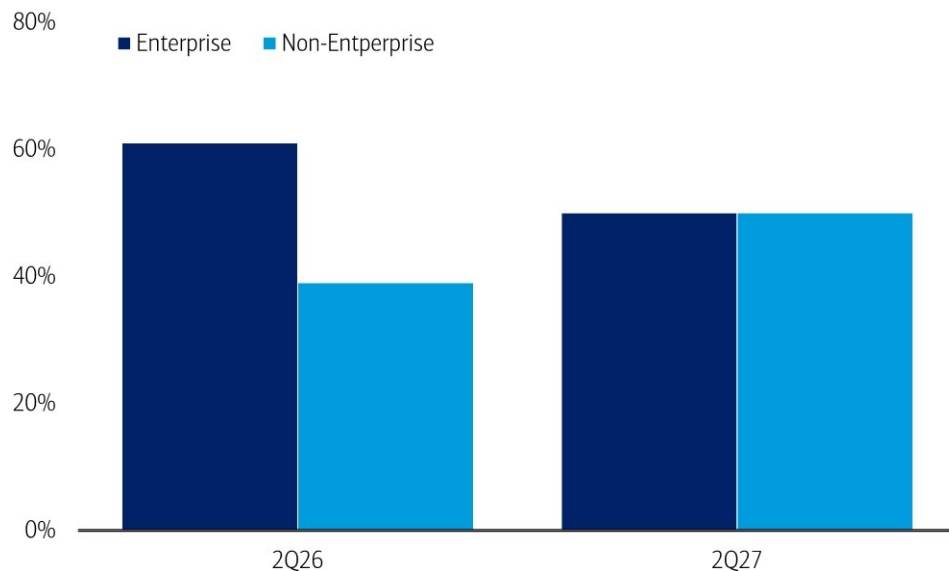


Falcon Flex remains the commercial engine

Falcon Flex is a commitment model rather than a consumption model, allowing customers to commit once and dynamically activate additional modules without renegotiating a full contract. Total Flex contract value is approaching \$2.3bn, up 101% y/y, with 935 new Flex opportunities added in the latest quarter. Average ending ARR uplift when a customer moves from non-Flex to Flex has increased to 40%, from 34% last year. Flex adoption has also broadened beyond large enterprises, with the mix shifting from 61% enterprise and 39% non-enterprise in 2Q26 to an even 50/50 split. Non-Flex contracts are expected to continue declining in mix as the company moves toward a Flex-first model. The architecture and commercial structure are particularly relevant for new AI products: Guardian can be activated immediately against an existing sensor deployment, while SafeMind token packs will be purchased and expanded through Flex. In our view, this combination of product breadth, preinstalled technology, and simplified procurement should help shorten adoption cycles and convert AI innovation into incremental ARR.

Exhibit 3: Falcon Flex enterprise vs non enterprise customer mix

Non-enterprise now represent 50% of Falcon Flex



Source: BofA Global Research estimates, company report

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

AI is needed to fight AI

The broader conference message was that AI is flattening the traditional “pyramid of pain.” Advanced offensive capabilities that previously required nation-state resources can increasingly be accessed by lower-skill adversaries, moving cybersecurity from the nation-state era toward an “agent-state” era. Agentic attacks are operating in seconds, at negligible cost and with minimal expertise, versus the longer dwell times and higher barriers historically associated with sophisticated attacks. Defending against this environment requires an integrated security architecture across runtime, identity, cloud, data, and response, with AI operating at inference speed. CrowdStrike’s strategic advantage is its ability to combine prompt visibility with endpoint and workload telemetry, identity context, threat intelligence, and automated response on a single platform. The Investor Day reinforced management’s view that AI Security will be bigger than Endpoint Security, and the adoption curve will be steeper than Cloud Security. As such, we expect Guardian to provide meaningful upsell potential across the base through FY27 & 28. We increase our estimates to capture some of the early ramp and management’s improved outlook.



Price objective basis & risk

CrowdStrike Holdings Inc. (CRWD)

Our PO of \$230 is based on roughly 32x our FY27E EV/Sales, which is a premium to high-growth Software as a Service (SaaS) peers, which trade closer to 13-19x. Our premium valuation is supported by CrowdStrike's strong competitive positioning in endpoint security and long-term growth opportunities across Cloud security, log management, and identity protection. In addition, we note CrowdStrike's higher growth profile and potential to take meaningful share in new markets that would increase the total addressable market (TAM) and potentially accelerate growth. The positives of CrowdStrike's high growth and long-term opportunities are somewhat offset by lower margins and expected growth deceleration.

Downside risks to our PO are 1) investor sentiment and sensitivity to the premium valuation levels, 2) a lower take-rate of new offerings, 3) potential slowdown in new customer adoption and expansion deals, 4) risk of security breaches, and 5) an increase in competition from incumbent vendors and newer next-generation players.

Analyst Certification

I, Tal Liani, hereby certify that the views expressed in this research report accurately reflect my personal views about the subject securities and issuers. I also certify that no part of my compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or view expressed in this research report.

US - Networking and Software Coverage Cluster

Investment rating	Company	BofA Ticker	Bloomberg symbol	Analyst
BUY				
	Akamai	AKAM	AKAM US	Tal Liani
	Amdocs	DOX	DOX US	Tal Liani
	Arista Networks	ANET	ANET US	Tal Liani
	Asana	ASAN	ASAN US	Matt Bullock
	Atlassian Corp	TEAM	TEAM US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Autodesk	ADSK	ADSK US	Tomer Zilberman
	Bentley Systems	BSY	BSY US	Tomer Zilberman
	Box Inc	BOX	BOX US	Matt Bullock
	Ciena	CIEN	CIEN US	Tal Liani
	Cisco Systems	CSCO	CSCO US	Tal Liani
	Cloudflare	NET	NET US	Tal Liani
	Coreweave	CRWV	CRWV US	Tal Liani
	Datadog Inc	DDOG	DDOG US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Dynatrace	DT	DT US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Extreme Networks, Inc.	EXTR	EXTR US	Tomer Zilberman
	Figma	FIG	FIG US	Tal Liani
	Fortinet	FTNT	FTNT US	Tal Liani
	Global-e Online Ltd.	GLBE	GLBE US	Matt Bullock
	JFrog Ltd	FROG	FROG US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Microsoft Corporation	MSFT	MSFT US	Tal Liani
	MongoDB Inc	MDB	MDB US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Motorola Solutions	MSI	MSI US	Tomer Zilberman
	Nebius Group N.V.	NBIS	NBIS US	Tal Liani
	Oracle Corporation	ORCL	ORCL US	Tal Liani
	Palo Alto Networks	PANW	PANW US	Tal Liani
	Samsara	IOT	IOT US	Matt Bullock
	SentinelOne, Inc.	S	S US	Tal Liani
	ServiceNow	NOW	NOW US	Tal Liani
	Shopify, Inc.	SHOP	SHOP US	Tal Liani
	Snowflake	SNOW	SNOW US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Twilio	TWLO	TWLO US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Zeta Global	ZETA	ZETA US	Matt Bullock
	Zoom Communications	ZM	ZM US	Matt Bullock



US - Networking and Software Coverage Cluster

Investment rating	Company	BofA Ticker	Bloomberg symbol	Analyst
	Zscaler	ZS	ZS US	Tal Liani
NEUTRAL				
	Amplitude, Inc.	AMPL	AMPL US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Check Point Software Technologies	CHKP	CHKP US	Tal Liani
	CrowdStrike Holdings Inc.	CRWD	CRWD US	Tal Liani
	Elastic NV	ESTC	ESTC US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	GitLab Inc.	GTLB	GTLB US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Intuit	INTU	INTU US	Tal Liani
	Monday.com	MNDY	MNDY US	Matt Bullock
	Okta Inc	OKTA	OKTA US	Tal Liani
	SailPoint	SAIL	SAIL US	Tal Liani
	Workday Inc.	WDAY	WDAY US	Tal Liani
UNDERPERFORM				
	Adobe	ADBE	ADBE US	Tal Liani
	BlackLine, Inc.	BL	BL US	Tomer Zilberman
	C3.ai	AI	AI US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Coveo	YCVO	CVO CN	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Docusign Inc	DOCU	DOCU US	Matt Bullock
	Dropbox	DBX	DBX US	Matt Bullock
	F5 Inc	FFIV	FFIV US	Tal Liani
	Fastly	FSLY	FSLY US	Tal Liani
	HubSpot, Inc.	HUBS	HUBS US	Matt Bullock
	Lightspeed Commerce Inc.	LSPD	LSPD US	Matt Bullock
	Lightspeed Commerce Inc.	YLSPD	LSPD CN	Matt Bullock
	PagerDuty	PD	PD US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	Salesforce Inc	CRM	CRM US	Tal Liani
	UiPath	PATH	PATH US	Koji Ikeda, CFA
	ZoomInfo	GTM	GTM US	Matt Bullock

iQmethodSM Measures Definitions

Business Performance

Return On Capital Employed

Return On Equity

Operating Margin

Earnings Growth

Free Cash Flow

Numerator

NOPAT = (EBIT + Interest Income) × (1 – Tax Rate) + Goodwill Amortization

Net Income

Operating Profit

Expected 5 Year CAGR From Latest Actual

Cash Flow From Operations – Total Capex

Denominator

Total Assets – Current Liabilities + ST Debt + Accumulated Goodwill

Amortization

Shareholders' Equity

Sales

N/A

N/A

Quality of Earnings

Cash Realization Ratio

Asset Replacement Ratio

Tax Rate

Net Debt-To-Equity Ratio

Interest Cover

Numerator

Cash Flow From Operations

Capex

Tax Charge

Net Debt = Total Debt – Cash & Equivalents

EBIT

Denominator

Net Income

Depreciation

Pre-Tax Income

Total Equity

Interest Expense

Valuation Toolkit

Price / Earnings Ratio

Price / Book Value

Dividend Yield

Free Cash Flow Yield

Enterprise Value / Sales

Numerator

Current Share Price

Current Share Price

Annualised Declared Cash Dividend

Cash Flow From Operations – Total Capex

EV = Current Share Price × Current Shares + Minority Equity + Net Debt +

Other LT Liabilities

Enterprise Value

Denominator

Diluted Earnings Per Share (Basis As Specified)

Shareholders' Equity / Current Basic Shares

Current Share Price

Market Cap = Current Share Price × Current Basic Shares

Sales

EV / EBITDA

Basic EBIT + Depreciation + Amortization

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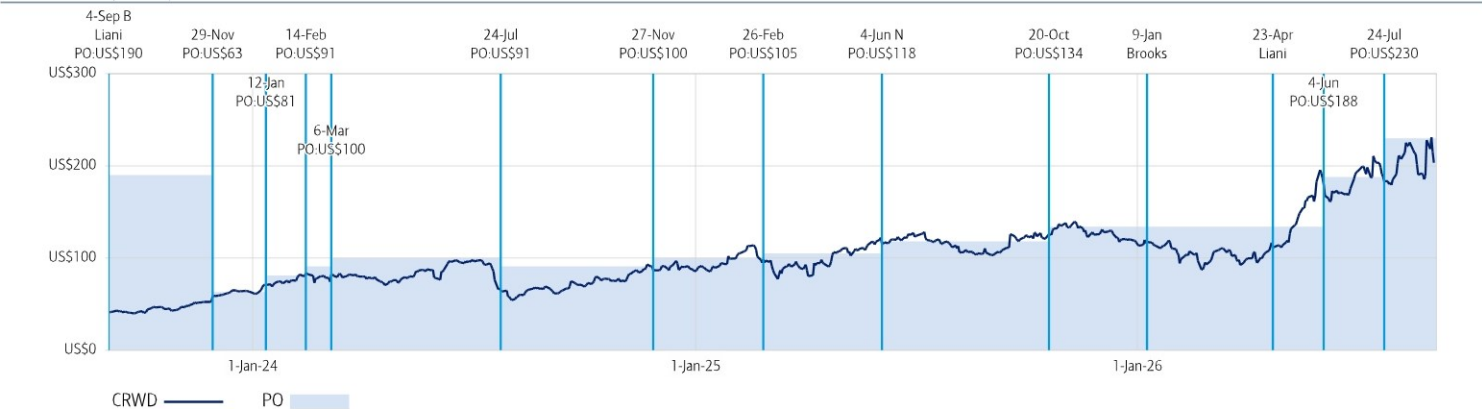
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Disclosures

Important Disclosures

CrowdStrike (CRWD) Price Chart



B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

The Investment Opinion System is contained at the end of the report under the heading 'Fundamental Equity Opinion Key'. Dark grey shading indicates the security is restricted with the opinion suspended. Medium grey shading indicates the security is under review with the opinion withdrawn. Light grey shading indicates the security is not covered. Chart is current as of a date no more than one trading day prior to the date of the report.

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Telecommunications Group (as of 30 Jun 2026)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	55	53.92%	Buy	38	69.09%
Hold	19	18.63%	Hold	13	68.42%
Sell	28	27.45%	Sell	20	71.43%

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Global Group (as of 30 Jun 2026)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	1987	56.11%	Buy	1190	59.89%
Hold	797	22.51%	Hold	496	62.23%
Sell	757	21.38%	Sell	391	51.65%

^{R1} Issuers that were investment banking clients of BofA Securities or one of its affiliates within the past 12 months. For purposes of this Investment Rating Distribution, the coverage universe includes only stocks. A stock rated Neutral is included as a Hold, and a stock rated Underperform is included as a Sell.

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Investment rating	Total return expectation (within 12-month period of date of initial rating)	Ratings dispersion guidelines for coverage cluster ^{R2}
Buy	≥ 10%	≤ 70%
Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

^{R2} Ratings dispersions may vary from time to time where BofA Global Research believes it better reflects the investment prospects of stocks in a Coverage Cluster.

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